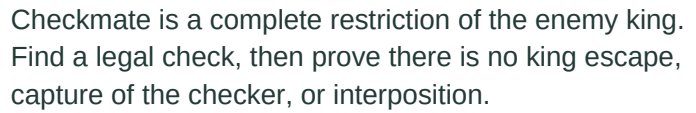


Mate in one

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Inspect the king's flight squares before choosing a check. A protected queen or a distant rook may cover the last escape in different ways.

Previous move: 9.Nxd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

9...Qxc1#

9...Qxc1# Mate: queen on c1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on e1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on c1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

A checking piece next to the king must be protected unless the king cannot capture it for another legal reason.